The Great Proclamation

The relationship between the homeland and the new colonies continued to decline after the mid-18th century. Canada was in the hands of the British but it had been an expensive endeavor. In 1763, the British issued the Great Proclamation that caused uproar among the colonists. It stated that the colonists could not settle anywhere further than the start of the rivers, which ended in the Atlantic Ocean. This announcement went ignored and tensions continued to grow because the colonists wished to create settlements in different parts of the land.

The next year saw the passing of the Sugar Act that is officially known as the American Revenue Act. At the time, the colonists were not paying as much taxes as the British citizens and the British government wished to change the agreement. The Act forced the colonists to pay higher taxes on molasses and the colonists' resentment deepened even more.

It was the Stamp Act issued in 1765 that resulted in the saying *No Taxation Without Representation*. The British began taxing newspapers and cards, which greatly angered the colonists. They retaliated by boycotting goods from Britain and stopped paying debts to British traders. When the British saw what had happened, they repealed the Stamp Act in the following year. They then issued the Declaratory Act which stated that the British government ruled the colonies in America.

Two years later, Charles Townshend began taxing tea, oil, paints and other goods. The Americans boycotted the goods from Britain again and Britain was forced to repeal the taxes. In 1770, the British government required taxes only on tea because all other types of goods had become exempt from taxation.